doing?”

“He couldn’t have,” Léa said. “Your imagination is working overtime. Good for art but not for practical matters.”

“But I—”

“If we don’t go, the smuggler will think Édouard kept the wine for himself. We have to move tonight. It’s the only way to keep Paulette and Virginie safe.”

That was the heart of it. Hearing it again gave Rose the impetus and strength to push forward. She recalled all they’d already gone through to prepare—walking to the jetty early in the morning, then meeting Virginie on the towpath along the Loire. She’d just returned from delivering the food to Édouard, and showed the sisters where the tunnel ended so they could trace their way from it to the jetty, which took less than five minutes. She could risk five minutes of her life to keep the LeBlanc family safe.

“How many trips do you think it will take us to bring all the wine to the jetty?” Rose asked.

“If we can fit two cases in one wheelbarrow, and we both have a wheelbarrow and go back and forth, three trips at the most.”

“Less than thirty minutes and it will all be over,” Rose whispered, trying to reassure herself.

“That’s right. And you don’t have to go in the tunnel.”

“Good, because I’d never be able to.”

“Come on,” Léa said, let’s get the wheelbarrows ready. “Are you sure you can wheel them on your own to the tunnel’s outer door?”

Rose nodded. “I brought an old blanket to put on them to deaden the rattle of the glass. I’ll be fine.”

Minutes later, Rose was alone on the road, wheeling the carts through the darkness. A low humming sound broke the quiet—crickets—and hearing them made her less jumpy. She kept close to the side of the road, ready to steer the wheelbarrows onto the verge and hide in the darkness if she heard a bicycle or car. She thought about Léa underground, pushing the carts through the tunnel. Why wasn’t her sister scared? Rose would never understand Léa—how she could be so brave and bold.

Plane trees dotted the road. Rose took in the moonlight shining on the yellow-brown leaves. She wished she could be back at the house, working on the still life she’d started a few days ago. She’d sketched the moonlight